

better than a complicated solution that doesn't. Joel Spolsky writes about this in his blog post, "Don't Let the Astronaut Architects Scare You" at <https://www.joelonsoftware.com/2001/04/21/dont-let-architecture-astronauts-scare-you/>.

You should know how object-oriented concepts like inheritance work, because they can help you organize your code and make development and debugging easier. Due to Python's flexibility, the language not only offers OOP features, but also doesn't require you to use them when they aren't suited for your program's needs.

Multiple Inheritance

Many programming languages limit classes to at most one parent class. Python supports multiple parent classes by offering a feature called *multiple inheritance*. For example, we can have an `Airplane` class with a `flyInTheAir()` method and a `Ship` class with a `floatOnWater()` method. We could then create a `FlyingBoat` class that inherits from both `Airplane` and `Ship` by listing both in the `class` statement, separated by commas. Open a new file editor window and save the following as *flyingboat.py*:

```
class Airplane:
    def flyInTheAir(self):
        print('Flying...')

class Ship:
    def floatOnWater(self):
        print('Floating...')

class FlyingBoat(Airplane, Ship):
    pass
```

The `FlyingBoat` objects we create will inherit the `flyInTheAir()` and `floatOnWater()` methods, as you can see in the interactive shell:

```
>>> from flyingboat import *
>>> seaDuck = FlyingBoat()
>>> seaDuck.flyInTheAir()
Flying...
```